



The Soyuz Spacecraft in flight

nism, hatch and rendezvous antennas located at the front end.

The rendezvous antennas are used by the automated docking system – a radar-based system – to manoeuvre the vehicle towards desired objectives. In the future, a window would be added to this the module.

The opposite end of the Orbital Module connects to the Descent Module via a pressurized hatch. Before returning to Earth, the Orbital Module separates from the Descent Module – after the de-orbiting manoeuvre – and burns up upon re-entry into the atmosphere.

ii) Descent Module – The Descent Module is where the cosmonauts sit for launch, re-entry and landing. All the necessary controls and displays of the Soyuz are located here. The module also contains life support supplies and batteries used during descent, as well as the primary and backup parachutes and landing rockets.

It also contains custom-fitted seat liners for each crew-member's couch/seat, which are individually moulded to fit each person's body – this ensures a tight, comfortable fit when the module lands on the Earth.

The module has a peri-

